UNESCO

UNESCO, an agency of the UN based in Paris, France, was founded in 1946 to promote international collaboration for peace and security. It was established in line with the United Nations Charter, through education, science, and culture. Today, the organization has 195 member states.

UNESCO continues the work begun by the League of Nations International Committee on Intellectual Cooperation in the 1920s, which was interrupted by the outbreak of World War II. Today, members aim to achieve their objectives by sponsoring international educational and scientific programs. These include dedicated projects that promote and protect human rights and sustainable development, while encouraging cultural diversity.

The organization is perhaps best known for establishing internationally recognized World Heritage Sites, which aim to preserve as many aspects as possible of the world's diverse cultural and natural heritage.

See also: Human activity and biodiversity • The ecosystem • The peaceful coexistence of humankind and nature • Renewable energy • Environmental ethics • Sustainable Biosphere Initiative